

ANEXO HEIU B2 — STAR QUESTION BANK

> **FOR THE TEACHER:** Use this bank during Day 1 of the Portfolio Build Cycle. Pick 2 random questions per class — one for pairs, one for the volunteer recording. Rotate so students get different categories over the cycle.

> **FOR THE STUDENT:** The first 10 questions are the **MOST COMMON** in real interviews. Memorize a STAR-format answer for each one before you graduate B2.

STAR FORMAT REMINDER

S — Situation: When? Where? What was the context?
T — Task: What was YOUR specific responsibility?
A — Action: What did YOU do? (use "I", not "we")
R — Result: What was the outcome? (numbers if possible)

TIER 1 — THE TOP 10 (memorize these first)

These appear in 80% of professional interviews. Master them.

1. Tell me about yourself.

(60-second pitch — same structure as your video pitch)

2. Why do you want this job?

(Connect what THEY offer to what YOU want next)

3. Tell me about a time you faced a difficult challenge at work and how you handled it.

4. Tell me about a time you had to work with a difficult team member.

5. Describe a situation where you had to meet a tight deadline. How did you handle it?

6. Give me an example of a time you took initiative without being asked.

7. Tell me about a mistake you made and what you learned from it.

8. Describe a time when you had to learn something new quickly.

9. Tell me about a time you led a project or a team.

10. Where do you see yourself in 5 years?

TIER 2 — LEADERSHIP & TEAMWORK (15)

11. Tell me about a time you had to motivate a team that was losing energy.

12. Describe a situation where you disagreed with your manager. How did you handle it?

13. Tell me about a time you mentored or trained someone.

14. Give me an example of a successful team you were part of. What made it successful?

15. Describe a time you delegated a task. How did you decide who to give it to?

16. Tell me about a time when team members had different opinions. How did you reach a decision?

17. Describe a situation where you had to lead without formal authority.

18. Tell me about a time you had to give difficult feedback to a colleague.

19. Give me an example of when you helped someone else succeed.

20. Describe a time when you had to manage up — handling expectations of a senior person.

21. Tell me about a time you took on more responsibility than your role required.

22. Describe a situation where you helped resolve a conflict between two coworkers.

23. Tell me about a time you had to work with someone whose work style was very different from yours.

24. Give me an example of a time when team morale was low and what you did about it.

25. Describe a time when you had to onboard a new team member.

TIER 3 — PROBLEM-SOLVING & RESULTS (15)

26. Tell me about a time you solved a complex problem with limited information.

27. Describe a situation where you had to make a decision quickly without all the data.

28. Give me an example of a creative solution you came up with at work.

29. Tell me about a time you improved a process or workflow.

30. Describe a situation where you had to analyze data to make a recommendation.

31. Tell me about a time you had to convince others to adopt your idea.

32. Give me an example of a time you exceeded a goal or target.

33. Describe a situation where you saved your company time or money.

34. Tell me about a time when your initial approach failed. What did you do?
 35. Give me an example of when you had to handle multiple priorities at once.
 36. Describe a time when you predicted a problem before it happened. What did you do?
 37. Tell me about a time you had to make a decision with incomplete information.
 38. Give me an example of when you had to compromise on a project. How did you decide?
 39. Describe a situation where you turned around a project that was failing.
 40. Tell me about a time you had to defend your work or decision.
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TIER 4 — CLIENT/CUSTOMER & COMMUNICATION (10)

41. Tell me about a time you handled a difficult customer or client.
 42. Describe a situation where you had to explain a complex idea to someone non-technical.
 43. Give me an example of when you went above and beyond for a customer.
 44. Tell me about a time you had to deliver bad news to a client.
 45. Describe a situation where you had to negotiate with a client about scope or budget.
 46. Tell me about a time you turned an unhappy customer into a happy one.
 47. Give me an example of when communication broke down. How did you fix it?
 48. Describe a time when you had to present to senior leadership or executives.
 49. Tell me about a time you persuaded a stakeholder who was initially against your idea.
 50. Give me an example of when you handled criticism from a customer or peer.
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ROTATION GUIDE FOR THE TEACHER

Use this so each student gets variety across cycles.

- **Cycle 1, Day 1:** Tier 1, Question #3 (challenge) + #5 (deadline)
- **Cycle 2, Day 1:** Tier 1, #4 (difficult coworker) + #6 (initiative)
- **Cycle 3, Day 1:** Tier 1, #7 (mistake) + #9 (leadership)
- **Cycle 4, Day 1:** Tier 2, #14 (successful team) + #18 (difficult feedback)
- **Cycle 5, Day 1:** Tier 3, #29 (improved process) + #32 (exceeded goal)
- **Cycle 6, Day 1:** Tier 4, #41 (difficult customer) + #44 (bad news)
- **Cycle 7, Day 1:** Tier 1, #1 (tell me about yourself) + #2 (why this job)
- **Cycle 8, Day 1:** Tier 2, #21 (more responsibility) + #22 (resolve conflict)
- **Cycle 9, Day 1:** Tier 3, #38 (compromise) + #39 (turnaround)
- **Cycle 10, Day 1:** Tier 4, #48 (present to executives) + #50 (handle criticism)

After Cycle 10, rotate freely or repeat Tier 1 since those are graduation-critical.

GROUND RULES (FOR THE TEACHER)

1. **Pick questions BEFORE class.** Don't decide in the moment — students sense uncertainty.
 2. **Rotate categories.** Don't ask 5 leadership questions in a row.
 3. **Time strictly.** 90 seconds per answer. STAR forces conciseness.
 4. **Give pronunciation feedback ONLY.** Not strategy advice.
 5. **If a student freezes:** "Just answer Situation. Then we'll add Task and Action next time."
 6. **Encourage ALL languages of experience.** Every job, every internship, every volunteer experience counts. Even a wedding they organized counts as "led a team."
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WHAT YOU DO NOT DO

- ■ Coach them on what to say in their answer
- ■ Tell them their experience isn't impressive enough
- ■ Suggest they invent or exaggerate
- ■ Only model correct English form. The student decides the content.